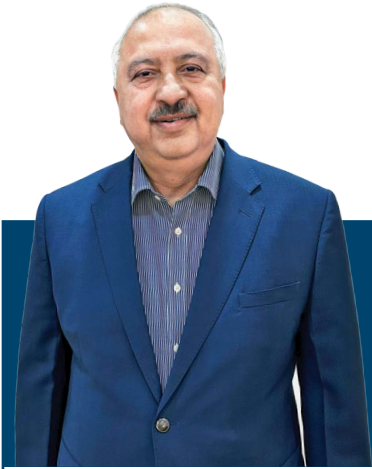




ATUL SINGH, 62

GROUP VICE CHAIRMAN,
RAYMOND GROUP

► Joined Raymond in July 2022. Long-time leader of Coca-Cola. Brings in deep understanding of global business and expertise in supply chain and distribution

"We are available in a lot of small towns. But there are hundreds of towns that we are probably not available in because our distribution network doesn't go that far. Those are opportunities for us to expand"



SUNIL KATARIA, 55

CEO-LIFESTYLE BUSINESS,
RAYMOND

► Joined Raymond in March 2022 from Godrej Consumer Products, where he was CEO for India and SAARC. Ace marketer and economics graduate

"Styling and fashion are becoming more personalised. Whatever I wear, do I stand apart in a crowd? So, this is an area where we have started investing a lot in terms of product and design"



HARMOHAN SAHNI, 55

CEO, RAYMOND REALTY

► Joined Raymond in June 2021. Real estate veteran of two decades and qualified CA. Brought in to shepherd Raymond's fledgeling realty business

"The mandate is to make real estate one of the key businesses of Raymond's growth. That is not going to happen only through the Thane land. So, our focus for the next four or five years is MMR as a larger playground"

In addition, the sale this April of its FMCG business to Godrej Consumer Products Ltd (GCPL) for ₹2,825 crore has given Raymond significant cash in hand to invest in its lifestyle businesses and pare debt further if necessary.

By any measure, it has been a spectacular turnaround, and with much acceleration yet to come on the runway.

BATTLING THE PANDEMIC

Let us begin at the beginning of Ray-

mond's slump. With the country going into lockdown in March 2020 and staying there in different shades for several months, Raymond's textile, apparel and garmenting business, comprising nearly 80 per cent of its overall revenues, were badly affected. "We had already pushed inventory, but there was no uptake. And in a fashion business, if stocks are not sold, they become old," recalls K.A. Narayan, 65, President-HR and a 15-year Raymond veteran. Plus, it also had manufacturing plants for these products, which

presented a different challenge. "If we continue to produce [stocks], we have a challenge in terms of where to dispatch them, what to do with them, and that gets added to the inventory. At the same time, if we don't produce, we have to shut down factories." This situation sparked fears of a liquidity crisis, and the Board was quick to alert the management of the need to cut costs and strengthen cash flows. Raymond then undertook a bunch of steps to cut overheads, reduce headcount and lower discretionary expenses.